

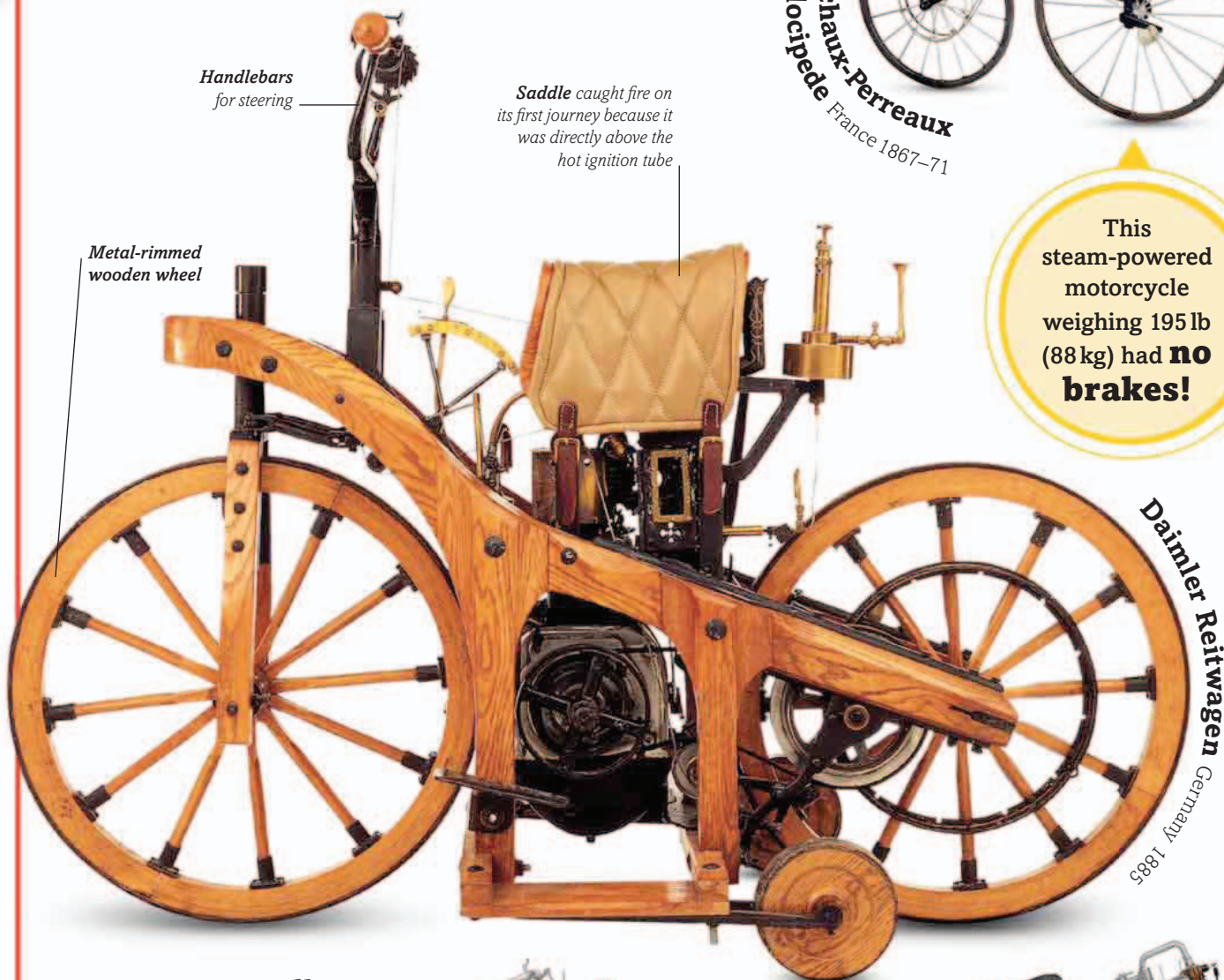


Revving up

Michaux-Perreaux
velocipede France 1867–71



This steam-powered motorcycle weighing 195 lb (88 kg) had **no brakes!**



Handlebars for steering

Saddle caught fire on its first journey because it was directly above the hot ignition tube

Metal-rimmed wooden wheel

Daimler Reitwagen Germany 1885

Hildebrand & Wolfmüller
Motorrad Germany 1894

Mudguard was also the motorcycle's water tank



Cyklon Germany 1901

The first powered motorcycles used a small steam engine to drive the rear wheel, but motorcycles made a great leap forward once internal combustion engines were built small enough to attach to a bicycle-styled frame.

With its 0.5 horsepower engine, the **Daimler Reitwagen** is considered to be the first “real” motorcycle, even though it was crafted out of wood. It proved to be an uncomfortable ride due to its wooden wheels and lack of suspension. The faster **Motorrad** and the first widely made